Case 1: Johnson v. Smith Realty (2016)
Tenant Alex Johnson filed a complaint against landlord Smith Realty for failing to return his security deposit after moving out, claiming deductions for wear and tear were excessive and not properly documented. The court ruled in favor of Johnson, ordering the full deposit return. The court held that deductions for normal wear and tear were impermissible under Real Property Law § 235 and emphasized that the landlord did not provide an itemized list within the required timeframe, violating statutory obligations. This ruling protects tenant rights regarding deposits.

Case 2: Martinez v. Brown Properties (2017)
Landlord Olivia Brown sought eviction of tenant Maria Martinez for non-payment of rent. Martinez argued that Brown had refused to make necessary repairs, making the apartment uninhabitable and thereby justifying withholding rent. The court ruled in favor of Brown, granting the eviction. The court highlighted that Martinez failed to formally notify the landlord of the uninhabitability issue, violating the requirements of RPAPL § 711. The landlord was within their rights to seek possession for non-payment despite the tenant's claims. This case clarifies landlord rights in eviction situations.

Case 3: Carter v. Wilson (2018)
Tenant Robert Carter contested a rent increase of more than 6% imposed by landlord Karen Wilson without the legally mandated 90-day notice, claiming it was unreasonably high for the area. The court ruled in favor of Carter, overturning the rent increase. The court found Wilson in violation of RPL § 226-c, affirming that any rent increase exceeding 5% requires a proper notice period. The lack of notice rendered the increase invalid, reinforcing tenant protections against sudden financial burdens. This decision ensures landlords comply with notice requirements.

Case 4: Hayes v. Taylor (2019)
Tenant Jennifer Hayes accused landlord Michael Taylor of rent overcharges and argued that the apartment was improperly deregulated due to a lack of documentation supporting Taylor's claims of luxury status. The court ruled in favor of Hayes, ordering a rent reduction. The ruling emphasized the burden of proof on landlords to demonstrate compliance with regulations regarding luxury deregulation. The absence of appropriate registration and records led to the conclusion that Hayes was overcharged, ensuring protection against unfair rent practices. This case addresses rent overcharge issues.

Case 5: Nguyen v. Lee (2020)
Tenant Minh Nguyen sought rent abatement after suffering multiple issues with heat and hot water in the winter months, citing violations of the warranty of habitability

against landlord Emily Lee. The court ruled in favor of Nguyen, granting a partial abatement. The court upheld the warranty of habitability, confirming that landlords are required to provide essential services. The failure to deliver adequate heating warranted a rent reduction, reinstating tenant rights to habitability standards. This ruling maintains habitability standards.

Case 6: Roberts v. Green (2021)
Landlord James Green included unauthorized fees in the lease agreement with tenant Sarah Roberts, claiming they were for maintenance services. Roberts disputed these fees as being both unreasonable and not specified in the lease. The court ruled in favor of Roberts, deeming the fees invalid. The court highlighted that General Obligations Law § 7-108 dictates that only fees specified in the lease can be charged. The ruling underscored the importance of clear lease terms and tenant rights against unexpected costs. This case protects tenants from unauthorized fees.

Case 7: Thompson v. Grey (2022)
After the death of longtime tenant Kevin Thompson, his family member, Rachel Thompson, sought to take over the lease, but landlord Patricia Grey refused to recognize her rights as an eligible successor under the law. The court ruled in favor of Thompson, granting succession. The decision reaffirmed that under the relevant housing laws, family members living continuously with the tenant have succession rights. The court emphasized the need for landlords to recognize these rights to protect tenant families from unjust eviction. This ruling supports family succession rights.

Case 8: Miller v. DHCR (2023)
Landlord Daniel Miller contested a ruling by the DHCR denying an MCI rent increase based on purported improvements made to the building, arguing that they were necessary for compliance with safety codes. The court ruled in favor of tenant Emily Johnson, denying the MCI increase. The ruling determined that Miller did not provide sufficient evidence that the improvements were necessary or directly benefited tenants. The court emphasized that landlords must adhere to strict standards in claiming MCI increases, safeguarding tenant interests against unjustified rent hikes. This ruling holds landlords accountable for MCI claims.